heavily on Indian assistance. Most of the wealth generated from British policy either stayed in the hands of the colonial powers or may have helped the Indian population, which was assisting the colonial administration through the influx of a professional class including bankers and businessmen. The Chettiyars, Indian moneylenders from Madras, became a dominant force in Burmese society. An Indian governing model was developed, which included taxation and land tenure. Cheap Indian labor and the importing of foreign goods further diminished the economic situation of the Burmese population. All of these policies led to intense resentment from the Burmese population. By the start of World War I, Burma was suffering significant social disorder and chaos.

Complicating the situation in Burma was the influx of immigrants into the country. A massive influx of immigrants from southeastern India and southeastern China arrived from the late-19th century through the first three decades of the 20th century. Rangoon hosted the largest Chinese population in all of Burma. The Indian population was evenly distributed with a larger percentage in Lower Burma, especially in Rangoon. By the early 1920s the majority of residents in the city were of Indian descent.

The Burmese began to associate the influx of immigrants with the British covert discriminatory policy against the indigenous population. The common notion that the British considered the Burmese too backward for equal treatment, too lazy to compete with the Indians for manual labor, and too inept to compete commercially with the Chinese exacerbated tensions with the immigrant community. The Burmese belief of exclusionary practice is born out in the fact that immigrants indeed dominated commerce, industry, and bureaucracy. The immigrant success stories throughout Burma played a significant role in attracting more immigrants to the region.

CULTURAL AND RELIGIOUS CHALLENGES

Formal education was largely shaped by a Buddhist cosmology and its cultural values. Traditionally education was rooted in the monastic mission to preserve the dharma. Scholarship and teaching were extensions of a religious vocation. Buddhist monasteries provided basic literacy for Burmese young people. Monks embodied Buddhist learning, and the